
AirPen Glove

Laptop Edition — No Raspberry Pi, No OLED

GY-BNO055 + 2 Flex Sensors + ESP32 + Your Laptop

Simpler setup — everything runs on your laptop

- ✓ ESP32 connects to laptop via **USB cable** (no Bluetooth pairing)
- ✓ Output shown on **laptop screen** (no OLED wiring)
- ✓ Recognition runs on **laptop CPU** (much faster than Pi)
- ✓ No Raspberry Pi setup, no SD card, no Linux config
- ✓ Same `airwrite.py` you already have — only 3 lines change

You already have: BNO055, 2x flex sensors, ESP32, glove, breadboard, wires, double-sided tape

Still need to buy: 10k Ω resistors (10 pcs, $\approx$ 20 BDT)

Build time: 2 hours

Skill level: Complete beginner

Project: AirPen — Computer Interfacing, MIST

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1. What Changes Without Pi and OLED

Table 1: Laptop edition vs Raspberry Pi edition

Part	Pi edition	Laptop edition (this guide)
Data link	Bluetooth pairing	USB cable — plug and play
Processing	Raspberry Pi 4 CPU	Your laptop CPU (10x faster)
Output display	128×64 OLED screen	Laptop screen (OpenCV window)
Power for glove	LiPo battery + charger	USB from laptop
Setup time	3–4 hours	30 minutes
Extra parts needed	Pi, SD card, OLED, battery	Nothing extra

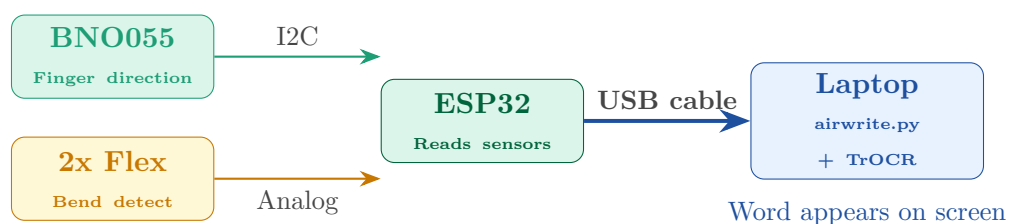
Removing the Pi and OLED eliminates the two hardest parts of the build — Linux configuration and Bluetooth pairing. The USB connection is instant and never drops. Your laptop runs TrOCR or Google Cloud Vision far faster than a Pi ever could, so recognition takes under 1 second instead of 4–6 seconds.

2. One Thing To Buy

You need **10kΩ resistors** — buy a pack of 10 from any electronics shop. Without them the flex sensors output meaningless values.

How to identify: colour bands are **Brown – Black – Orange – Gold**.

3. How The System Works



3.1. What Each Part Does

GY-BNO055 — Mounted on your index finger. Contains an accelerometer, gyroscope and magnetometer, and fuses all three internally to give clean orientation angles. As you move your finger to write, this reports which direction it is pointing 100 times per second.

Flex sensors — Strips that change resistance when bent. One on the index finger detects “pen down”. One on the middle finger triggers word recognition. They replace the thumb-touch and peace-sign gestures from the camera version.

ESP32 over USB — Reads all sensors and streams the data as CSV lines over the USB serial port. Your laptop reads this exactly like reading from any serial device. No Bluetooth, no pairing, no drivers to install on most systems.

4. Complete Circuit Wiring

4.1. Full Pin Connection Table

Table 2: Every wire connection — follow this exactly

Wire	From	Pin	To ESP32	Notes
Red	BNO055	VIN	3.3V	NEVER 5V
Black	BNO055	GND	GND	Any GND pin
Blue	BNO055	SDA	GPIO 21	I2C data line
Yellow	BNO055	SCL	GPIO 22	I2C clock line
Red	Flex 1 (index)	Pin 1	3.3V	Top of divider
Purple	Flex 1 (index)	Pin 2	GPIO 34	Midpoint read
Black	10kΩ #1	Leg 2	GND	Bottom of divider
Red	Flex 2 (middle)	Pin 1	3.3V	Top of divider
Purple	Flex 2 (middle)	Pin 2	GPIO 35	Midpoint read
Black	10kΩ #2	Leg 2	GND	Bottom of divider
—	ESP32	USB	Laptop USB port	Power + data + programming

The BNO055 runs on **3.3V only**. Connecting VIN to the ESP32's 5V pin will permanently kill the chip within seconds. Trace the red wire with your finger and confirm it goes to the pin labelled **3V3** or **3.3V**, not **VIN** or **5V** on the ESP32.

4.2. Wiring Diagram

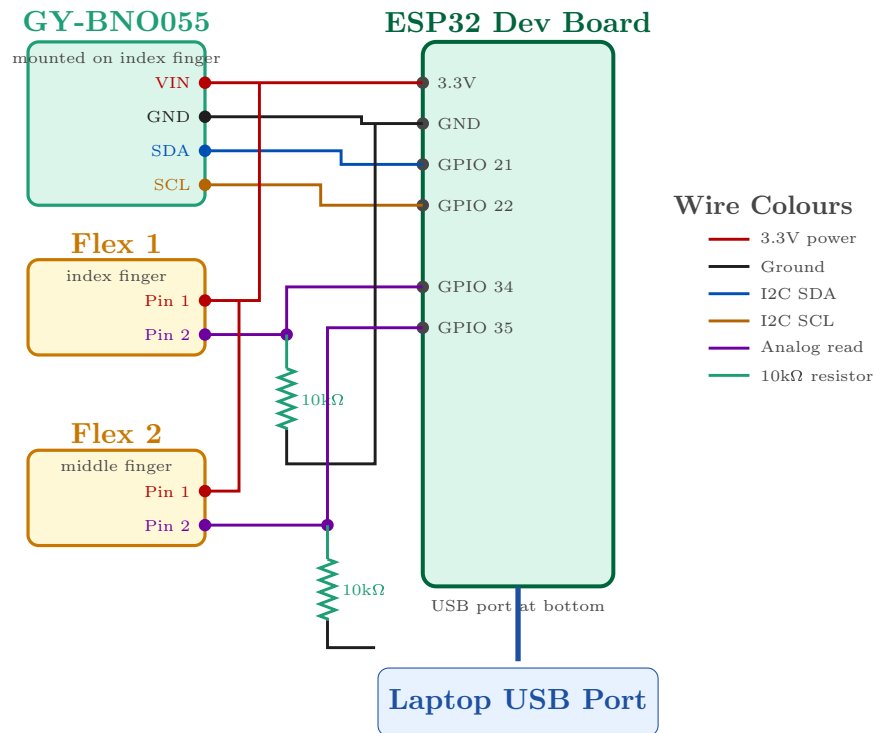


Figure 1: Complete wiring — BNO055 and two flex sensors to ESP32, ESP32 to laptop via USB

4.3. Breadboard Placement

Table 3: Where each component goes on your breadboard

Row	Column	Component / connection
<i>Power rails (long strips along the edges)</i>		
—	red (+) rail	Wire from ESP32 3.3V pin
—	blue (-) rail	Wire from ESP32 GND pin
<i>ESP32 board</i>		
1–15	a–e, f–j	ESP32 straddling the centre gap
<i>BNO055 sensor</i>		
20	a	BNO055 VIN wire
20	b	Jumper to red (+) rail
21	a	BNO055 GND wire
21	b	Jumper to blue (-) rail
22	a	BNO055 SDA wire
22	b	Jumper to ESP32 GPIO 21
23	a	BNO055 SCL wire
23	b	Jumper to ESP32 GPIO 22
<i>Flex sensor 1 (index finger)</i>		
26	a	Flex 1 Pin 1
26	b	Jumper to red (+) rail
27	a	Flex 1 Pin 2
27	b	Jumper to ESP32 GPIO 34
27	c	10k Ω resistor leg 1
28	c	10k Ω resistor leg 2
28	d	Jumper to blue (-) rail
<i>Flex sensor 2 (middle finger)</i>		
31	a	Flex 2 Pin 1
31	b	Jumper to red (+) rail
32	a	Flex 2 Pin 2
32	b	Jumper to ESP32 GPIO 35
32	c	10k Ω resistor leg 1
33	c	10k Ω resistor leg 2
33	d	Jumper to blue (-) rail

Each numbered row has 5 holes on the left (a–e) and 5 on the right (f–j). All 5 holes in a row on the same side are electrically connected. So if you put a wire in 27a and another in 27b, they are connected. The gap in the middle separates left from right — that is where the ESP32 straddles.

5. Physical Glove Assembly

Put the glove on your writing hand and mark with a pen:

- **Zone A** — top of index finger, middle segment (BNO055 goes here)
- **Zone B** — along index finger, base to tip (flex sensor 1)
- **Zone C** — along middle finger, base to tip (flex sensor 2)
- **Zone D** — flat area on back of hand (breadboard)

Take the glove off. These marks guide every mounting step.

1. Cut double-sided tape to the size of the BNO055 board
2. Stick it to the underside of the module (the side without the chip)
3. Press onto Zone A firmly, hold 45 seconds
4. **Check alignment:** view the finger from the side — the board must be *parallel* to the finger, not tilted

The BNO055 reports orientation relative to its own body. If the board is tilted 15 degrees, every reading is offset by 15 degrees, and your written letters will come out skewed. Fix the alignment now — it cannot be corrected in software.

1. Lay flex sensor 1 along Zone B (top of index finger, base to tip)
2. Secure with 3 small pieces of tape — base, middle, near tip
3. Repeat with flex sensor 2 along Zone C on the middle finger
4. **Test:** bend each finger — the sensor should flex smoothly, not buckle or crease

1. Apply double-sided tape to the bottom of the breadboard
2. Press onto Zone D
3. Seat the ESP32 on the breadboard, straddling the centre gap
4. Orient the ESP32 so its **USB port faces the wrist** — the cable then runs down your arm instead of across your fingers

1. Run wires along the **side** of each finger, never across the palm
2. Tape every 2cm with small strips
3. **Leave a 2cm loop of slack at every knuckle** — this is the single most important detail
4. Connect each wire end to the breadboard per the table in Section 4.3

Forgetting slack at the knuckles. When you bend a finger, the distance the wire must cover increases. Without slack the wire pulls on the solder joint, causing intermittent dropouts that look like random sensor failures and take hours to diagnose.

6. ESP32 Firmware

6.1. Arduino IDE Setup

1. Download Arduino IDE from arduino.cc/en/software
2. **File** → **Preferences** → Additional boards manager URLs, paste:
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/espressif/arduino-esp32/gh-pages/package_esp32_index.json
3. **Tools** → **Board** → **Boards Manager** → search “esp32” → Install
4. **Tools** → **Board** → select **ESP32 Dev Module**
5. **Tools** → **Manage Libraries** → install **Adafruit BNO055** and **Adafruit Unified Sensor**
6. Plug the ESP32 into your laptop, then **Tools** → **Port** → select the COM port that appears

Install the CP2102 or CH340 USB driver — which one depends on your ESP32 board. Search “CP2102 driver” or “CH340 driver”, install, then unplug and replug the ESP32.

6.2. Complete Firmware — USB Serial Version

Listing 1: glove_firmware.ino - upload this to the ESP32

```

1 // =====
2 // AirPen Glove Firmware - LAPTOP / USB EDITION
3 // Reads BNO055 orientation + 2 flex sensors
4 // Streams CSV over USB serial at 100 Hz
5 // =====
6
7 #include <Wire.h>
8 #include <Adafruit_Sensor.h>
9 #include <Adafruit_BNO055.h>
10
11 // Pin definitions (match the wiring table)
```



```

12 #define FLEX_INDEX_PIN    34    // flex sensor on index finger
13 #define FLEX_MIDDLE_PIN   35    // flex sensor on middle finger
14 #define SDA_PIN           21    // I2C data
15 #define SCL_PIN           22    // I2C clock
16
17 //      BNO055 object
18 Adafruit_BNO055 bno = Adafruit_BNO055(55, 0x28);
19
20 //      Flex thresholds - CALIBRATE THESE (see Section 6.3)
21 int FLEX_INDEX_THRESHOLD = 2700; // above this = pen DOWN
22 int FLEX_MIDDLE_THRESHOLD = 2700; // above this = recognise gesture
23
24 //      Send rate
25 unsigned long lastSend = 0;
26 const int RATE_MS = 10;          // 10ms = 100 samples/second
27
28 void setup() {
29     // USB serial to laptop - must match the Python side
30     Serial.begin(115200);
31     delay(500);
32
33     Serial.println("# AirPen Glove starting");
34
35     // Start I2C on the pins we wired
36     Wire.begin(SDA_PIN, SCL_PIN);
37
38     if (!bno.begin()) {
39         Serial.println("# ERROR: BNO055 not found");
40         Serial.println("# Check VIN->3.3V, GND->GND, SDA->21, SCL->22");
41         while (1) delay(1000);
42     }
43
44     delay(500);
45     bno.setMode(OPERATION_MODE_NDOF); // full 9-DOF fusion
46     delay(1000);
47
48     Serial.println("# BNO055 OK - calibrating");
49     Serial.println("# Move the glove in a figure-8 for ~20 seconds");
50
51     // Wait until the system calibration is at least 2 of 3
52     uint8_t sys = 0, gyro = 0, accel = 0, mag = 0;
53     int tries = 0;
54     do {
55         bno.getCalibration(&sys, &gyro, &accel, &mag);
56         // Lines starting with # are status messages, not data
57         Serial.printf("# CAL sys=%d gyro=%d accel=%d mag=%d\n",
58             sys, gyro, accel, mag);
59         delay(500);
60         tries++;
61     } while (sys < 2 && tries < 60);
62
63     Serial.println("# READY");
64 }
65
66 void loop() {
67     unsigned long now = millis();
68     if (now - lastSend < RATE_MS) return;
69     lastSend = now;
70
71     //      Orientation from BNO055 (degrees)
72     // x = heading    (0-360) --> maps to canvas X
73     // y = pitch      (-90..90) --> maps to canvas Y
74     // z = roll       (-180..180) --> unused for drawing
75     imu::Vector<3> e = bno.getVector(Adafruit_BNO055::VECTOR_EULER);
76
77     //      Flex sensors (0-4095, higher = more bent)
78     int flexIndex = analogRead(FLEX_INDEX_PIN);
79     int flexMiddle = analogRead(FLEX_MIDDLE_PIN);
80
81     bool penDown = (flexIndex > FLEX_INDEX_THRESHOLD);
82     bool gesture = (flexMiddle > FLEX_MIDDLE_THRESHOLD);
83
84     //      One CSV line per sample

```

```

85 // heading,pitch,roll,flexIndex,flexMiddle,penDown,gesture
86 Serial.print(e.x(), 2);      Serial.print(',');
87 Serial.print(e.y(), 2);      Serial.print(',');
88 Serial.print(e.z(), 2);      Serial.print(',');
89 Serial.print(flexIndex);     Serial.print(',');
90 Serial.print(flexMiddle);     Serial.print(',');
91 Serial.print(penDown ? 1 : 0); Serial.print(',');
92 Serial.println(gesture ? 1 : 0);
93 }

```

6.3. Calibrating the Flex Sensors

1. Upload the firmware, then open **Tools** → **Serial Monitor** at **115200 baud**
2. Hold your index finger completely straight — note the 4th number in each line
3. Bend the index finger to a comfortable “closed” position — note the 4th number again
4. Set `FLEX_INDEX_THRESHOLD` to roughly halfway between those two values
5. Repeat with the middle finger for the 5th number, set `FLEX_MIDDLE_THRESHOLD`
6. Re-upload the firmware with your values

Straight index reads **1850**. Bent index reads **3450**. Halfway is $(1850 + 3450)/2 = 2650$. Set `FLEX_INDEX_THRESHOLD = 2650`.

7. Laptop Software

7.1. Install Python Package

Only one package is needed beyond what you already have:

```
pip install pyserial
```

7.2. Finding Your ESP32 Serial Port

OS	Port looks like	How to find it
Windows	COM3, COM5	Device Manager → Ports (COM & LPT)
Linux	/dev/ttyUSB0	Run <code>ls /dev/ttyUSB*</code>
macOS	/dev/cu.usbserial-*	Run <code>ls /dev/cu.*</code>

Or list them from Python:

```
python -c "import serial.tools.list_ports as p; [print(x.device, '-', x.description) for x in p.comports()]"
```

7.3. glove_reader.py — Save This Next To airwrite.py

Listing 2: glove_reader.py - reads the glove over USB serial

```

1 # =====
2 # AirPen Glove Reader - LAPTOP / USB EDITION
3 # Reads CSV from ESP32 over USB serial in a background thread
4 # Converts BNO055 orientation into canvas X-Y coordinates
5 # =====
6
7 import serial
8 import threading
9 import time
10
11 # CONFIGURE THESE
12 SERIAL_PORT = "COM3" # Windows: COM3 | Linux: /dev/ttyUSB0
13 BAUD_RATE = 115200
14 CANVAS_W = 1280 # must match your airwrite.py canvas
15 CANVAS_H = 720
16
17 # How many canvas pixels per degree of finger rotation.
18 # Bigger = letters get bigger with less hand movement.
19 # Smaller = you must move your hand more to draw the same size.
20 SCALE = 12.0
21
22 # Ignore movements smaller than this (degrees) - kills sensor noise
23 DEADZONE = 0.35
24
25 # Shared state, guarded by a lock
26 _state = {
27     "canvas_x": CANVAS_W // 2,
28     "canvas_y": CANVAS_H // 2,
29     "pen_down": False,
30     "gesture": False,
31     "ready": False,
32     "flex_i": 0,
33     "flex_m": 0,
34 }
35 _lock = threading.Lock()
36
37 # Position integration state
38 _pos_x = float(CANVAS_W // 2)
39 _pos_y = float(CANVAS_H // 2)
40 _prev_heading = None
41 _prev_pitch = None
42 _running = False
43
44
45 def _parse(line):
46     """Parse one CSV line. Lines starting with # are status messages."""
47     line = line.strip()
48     if not line or line.startswith("#"):
49         return None
50     parts = line.split(",")
51     if len(parts) != 7:
52         return None
53     try:
54         return {
55             "heading": float(parts[0]),
56             "pitch": float(parts[1]),
57             "roll": float(parts[2]),
58             "flex_i": int(parts[3]),
59             "flex_m": int(parts[4]),
60             "pen_down": parts[5] == "1",
61             "gesture": parts[6] == "1",
62         }
63     except ValueError:
64         return None
65
66
67 def _integrate(heading, pitch):
68     """Turn change-in-angle into change-in-position on the canvas."""
69     global _pos_x, _pos_y, _prev_heading, _prev_pitch

```

```

70
71     if _prev_heading is None:
72         _prev_heading, _prev_pitch = heading, pitch
73         return int(_pos_x), int(_pos_y)
74
75     d_h = heading - _prev_heading
76     d_p = pitch - _prev_pitch
77
78     # Heading wraps at 360 - fix the jump
79     if d_h > 180: d_h -= 360
80     if d_h < -180: d_h += 360
81
82     # Dead zone kills jitter when holding still
83     if abs(d_h) < DEADZONE: d_h = 0.0
84     if abs(d_p) < DEADZONE: d_p = 0.0
85
86     _pos_x += d_h * SCALE
87     _pos_y -= d_p * SCALE          # minus so tilting up moves up on screen
88
89     _pos_x = max(0.0, min(float(CANVAS_W - 1), _pos_x))
90     _pos_y = max(0.0, min(float(CANVAS_H - 1), _pos_y))
91
92     _prev_heading, _prev_pitch = heading, pitch
93     return int(_pos_x), int(_pos_y)
94
95
96 def _reader(port, baud):
97     """Background thread - never blocks the main airwrite loop."""
98     global _running
99     print(f"[glove] opening {port} @ {baud}...")
100    try:
101        ser = serial.Serial(port, baud, timeout=1.0)
102    except serial.SerialException as ex:
103        print(f"[glove] CANNOT OPEN {port}: {ex}")
104        print("[glove] Close the Arduino Serial Monitor and try again.")
105        return
106
107    time.sleep(2.0)          # ESP32 resets when the port opens
108    ser.reset_input_buffer()
109    print("[glove] connected - waiting for calibration")
110    _running = True
111
112    while _running:
113        try:
114            raw = ser.readline().decode("utf-8", errors="ignore")
115
116            # Print status lines so you can see calibration progress
117            if raw.startswith("#"):
118                print("[glove]", raw.strip())
119                if "READY" in raw:
120                    with _lock:
121                        _state["ready"] = True
122                    continue
123
124            d = _parse(raw)
125            if d is None:
126                continue
127
128            cx, cy = _integrate(d["heading"], d["pitch"])
129            with _lock:
130                _state["canvas_x"] = cx
131                _state["canvas_y"] = cy
132                _state["pen_down"] = d["pen_down"]
133                _state["gesture"] = d["gesture"]
134                _state["flex_i"] = d["flex_i"]
135                _state["flex_m"] = d["flex_m"]
136                _state["ready"] = True
137
138        except Exception as ex:
139            print(f"[glove] read error: {ex}")
140            time.sleep(0.1)
141
142    ser.close()

```

```

143
144
145 def start(port=SERIAL_PORT, baud=BAUD_RATE):
146     """Call once at startup, before the main loop."""
147     t = threading.Thread(target=_reader, args=(port, baud), daemon=True)
148     t.start()
149
150
151 def stop():
152     global _running
153     _running = False
154
155
156 def get_state():
157     """
158     Call every frame from airwrite.py.
159     Returns (x, y, pen_down, gesture, ready)
160     """
161     with _lock:
162         return (_state["canvas_x"], _state["canvas_y"],
163                 _state["pen_down"], _state["gesture"],
164                 _state["ready"])
165
166
167 def get_flex():
168     """Raw flex values - useful for on-screen debugging."""
169     with _lock:
170         return _state["flex_i"], _state["flex_m"]
171
172
173 def recenter():
174     """Reset the cursor to canvas centre - call when a new word starts."""
175     global _pos_x, _pos_y, _prev_heading, _prev_pitch
176     _pos_x = float(CANVAS_W // 2)
177     _pos_y = float(CANVAS_H // 2)
178     _prev_heading = None
179     _prev_pitch = None

```

8. Integrating With airwrite.py

Three edits. Nothing else in your file changes — the canvas, TrOCR or Cloud Vision, word mode, and all the drawing code stay exactly as they are.

8.1. Edit 1 — Import and start the reader

Add near the top of `airwrite.py`, after your other imports:

```

1 import glove_reader
2
3 # Start the background USB reader. Change the port to match your machine.
4 glove_reader.start(port="COM3")      # Linux: "/dev/ttyUSB0"

```

8.2. Edit 2 — Replace the camera input block

Find the block in your main loop that reads MediaPipe landmarks:

```

1 # ---- OLD (camera version) ----
2 if lm:
3     draw_hand(frame, lm, w, h)
4     tip_x, tip_y = get_smooth_tip(lm, w, h)
5     gesture      = detect_gesture(lm)
6     pen_down     = get_pen_down(lm)

```

Replace it with:

```

1 # ---- NEW (glove version) ----
2 tip_x, tip_y, pen_down, glove_gesture, glove_ready = glove_reader.get_state()
3
4 if not glove_ready:
5     cv2.putText(frame, "Waiting for glove... move it in a figure-8",
6                 (20, 90), cv2.FONT_HERSHEY_SIMPLEX, 0.7,
7                 (0, 220, 255), 2)
8     gesture = "none"
9 else:
10    # Bending the middle finger acts as the "recognise" trigger,
11    # exactly where the peace sign used to be.
12    gesture = "peace" if glove_gesture else "index_up"
13
14    # Draw the cursor so you can see where the pen is on the canvas
15    cv2.circle(canvas, (tip_x, tip_y),
16               8 if pen_down else 5,
17               (0, 60, 200) if pen_down else (60, 60, 60), -1)

```

8.3. Edit 3 — Recentre when a new word starts

Find every place where the state becomes "drawing" and add one line after it:

```

1 state = "drawing"
2 glove_reader.recenter()      # <-- add this line

```

8.4. Optional — Show flex values on screen while tuning

Handy while you are dialling in the thresholds:

```

1 fi, fm = glove_reader.get_flex()
2 cv2.putText(frame, f"Flex index: {fi}    middle: {fm}",
3             (20, h - 130), cv2.FONT_HERSHEY_SIMPLEX,
4             0.5, (180, 180, 180), 1)

```

8.5. Control Mapping

Table 4: Camera gestures vs glove actions

Camera version	Glove version	Result
Move index finger	Move gloved hand	Cursor moves on canvas
Thumb touches index	Bend index finger	Pen DOWN — stroke drawn
Lift thumb	Straighten index	Pen UP — move without drawing
Peace sign	Bend middle finger	Recognise the word
Open palm	Press C on keyboard	Clear the canvas
—	Press U on keyboard	Undo the last stroke

9. Testing — Run These In Order

Upload this alone first:

```
1 #include <Wire.h>
2 #include <Adafruit_Sensor.h>
3 #include <Adafruit_BNO055.h>
4 Adafruit_BNO055 bno = Adafruit_BNO055(55, 0x28);
5 void setup() {
6   Serial.begin(115200);
7   Wire.begin(21, 22);
8   Serial.println(bno.begin() ? "BNO055 OK" : "BNO055 NOT FOUND");
9 }
10 void loop() {
11   imu::Vector<3> e = bno.getVector(Adafruit_BNO055::VECTOR_EULER);
12   Serial.printf("H %.1f P %.1f R %.1f\n", e.x(), e.y(), e.z());
13   delay(200);
14 }
```

Pass: “BNO055 OK” and three numbers that change as you tilt the sensor.

Fail: confirm VIN is on **3.3V** not 5V, SDA on GPIO21, SCL on GPIO22.

```
1 void setup() { Serial.begin(115200); }
2 void loop() {
3   Serial.printf("index %d middle %d\n",
4     analogRead(34), analogRead(35));
5   delay(120);
6 }
```

Pass: both numbers move by several hundred as you bend each finger.

Fail: a value stuck at 0 or 4095 means the 10kΩ resistor is missing or on the wrong leg.

Upload the complete firmware from Section 6. Open Serial Monitor at 115200.

Pass: status lines beginning with # during calibration, then continuous CSV lines like:

243.18,11.90,-2.35,1874,1902,0,0

Fail: if you only see # lines forever, the calibration never reached level 2 — keep moving the glove in a figure-8.

Close the Arduino Serial Monitor first — only one program can hold the port.

```
1 import glove_reader, time
2 glove_reader.start(port="COM3")      # your port here
3 time.sleep(3)
4 for _ in range(40):
5   x, y, pen, gest, ready = glove_reader.get_state()
6   fi, fm = glove_reader.get_flex()
7   print(f"x {x:4d} y {y:4d} pen {'DOWN' if pen else 'up '}")
8   f" gesture {int(gest)} ready {int(ready)}"
9   f" flex {fi}/{fm}"
10  time.sleep(0.1)
```

Pass: x and y change as you move your hand; pen shows DOWN when you bend your index finger.

Tune: if the cursor barely moves, raise **SCALE**. If it flies to the edge instantly, lower it.

```
python airwrite.py
```

Checklist:

1. Cursor dot appears on the canvas and follows your hand
2. Bending the index finger turns the dot red
3. Moving with the index bent leaves a white stroke
4. Bending the middle finger and holding triggers recognition
5. The recognised word appears on your laptop screen

10. Tuning Guide

Table 5: What to change when something feels wrong

Symptom	Setting	Change it to
Letters come out too small	SCALE	Raise from 12 to 18 or 25
Cursor flies off the canvas	SCALE	Lower from 12 to 6 or 8
Cursor drifts while holding still	DEADZONE	Raise from 0.35 to 0.6
Small movements ignored	DEADZONE	Lower from 0.35 to 0.2
Pen triggers too easily	FLEX_INDEX_THRESHOLD	Raise by 200–300
Pen will not trigger	FLEX_INDEX_THRESHOLD	Lower by 200–300
Strokes look jagged	STROKE_WIDTH in airwrite.py	Raise to 24–28
Writing is mirrored	In <code>_integrate</code>	Flip sign of <code>d_h</code>
Writing is upside down	In <code>_integrate</code>	Flip sign of <code>d_p</code>

11. Troubleshooting

Problem	Cause	Fix
BN0055 NOT FOUND	Wrong pin or 5V used	VIN to 3.3V, SDA 21, SCL 22
Access is denied on COM port	Serial Monitor still open	Close Arduino Serial Monitor
No COM port listed	USB driver missing	Install CP2102 or CH340 driver
Values freeze after a while	Loose wire at a knuckle	Add more slack at that joint
Flex stuck at 0 or 4095	Resistor missing / wrong leg	Rebuild the voltage divider
Cursor drifts on its own	Poor calibration	Redo the figure-8 for 30 seconds
Pen always down	Threshold too low	Raise <code>FLEX_INDEX_THRESHOLD</code>
Pen never down	Threshold too high	Lower <code>FLEX_INDEX_THRESHOLD</code>
Middle finger does nothing	Wrong threshold	Recalibrate <code>FLEX_MIDDLE_THRESHOLD</code>
Recognition always wrong	Strokes too small	Raise <code>SCALE</code> , write larger
ESP32 keeps resetting	Laptop USB underpowered	Use a rear USB port or powered hub